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Changes stagger community health sites

Nonprofits often care for the most needy. Now, they face uncertainty with Medicaid cuts, new prescription rules.

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

In many ways, Outer Cape Health Services had a great year. The community health center, which has locations in Harwich Port, Wellfleet, and Provincetown, was operating in the black, after running a \$2.3 million deficit in 2023. With finances stabilized, its executives had hopes to reach more patients in the 10 outermost towns on Cape

Cod. Instead, the health center is buckling down, facing a potential 30 to 40 percent decline in revenue over the next several years, and girding for layoffs, program cuts and more. They are not alone. In the coming years, a slew of changes from Washington will meaningfully alter the financial picture for the state's 50 community health centers, including shifts

in how their pharmacy programs are funded, how many of their current patients are insured, and perhaps what populations they can care for at all. Such challenges could be catastrophic for a crucial piece of Massachusetts' health care ecosystem. Health centers provide primary and mental health care, substance use disorder services, dental and vision care and far

HEALTH CENTERS, Page A7



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Unless the state intervenes, "There is no way all of us can survive this," Damian Archer of Outer Cape Health Services said.

US seeks fast deal to return hostages

Rubio admits steps to end war in Gaza will be tough

By Aaron Boxerman
NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Sunday the United States was hoping for a quick deal to bring home all hostages in the Gaza Strip as Israel and Hamas head into a new round of negotiations fraught with potential stumbling blocks.

Rubio acknowledged to NBC's "Meet the Press" that the next phase of negotiations on President Trump's plan to end the war in Gaza would be tougher, touching on fraught issues such as disarming Hamas and setting up a new government for Gaza that excludes the Palestinian militant group.

Asked whether the 2-year-old war was over, Rubio responded: "Well, not yet. There's some work that remains to be done." He went on to say that Hamas had "agreed to the president's hostage release framework."

Rubio spoke a day before a new round of indirect negotiations between Israel and Hamas was expected to begin in Egypt. Israel and Hamas do not speak directly, instead relying on Qatari and Egyptian mediators to act as go-betweens, ferrying messages back and forth.

MIDEAST, Page A5

►Protesters took to the streets in Greater Boston and in much of Europe and Africa. A3, B1.

Sidelines suit both parties in shutdown

Leaders agree on one thing: No quick solution to mess

By Annie Karni
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — At the White House, President Trump is posting artificial-intelligence-generated memes about the government shutdown, depicting his wonky budget director dressed as the Grim Reaper and ready to visit death on the federal bureaucracy.

In the Senate, Democrats show no sign of backing down from their demands in the shutdown fight, while Senator John Thune of South Dakota, the majority leader, has given verbal shrugs to reporters who ask about the status of his nonexistent negotiations with the other party about how to end the predicament.

"I don't know that there's a lot to sort out," Thune said on MSNBC on Friday, before sending senators home for the weekend.

And in the House, Speaker Mike Johnson has canceled votes for this week, telling his members they could stay home for the third-straight week given the shutdown logjam.

With Trump and lawmakers having made no progress on a deal that would reopen the government, one thing was clear as the partial shutdown headed into its second workweek: There was little sense of urgency in Washington about cleaning up a

SHUTDOWN, Page A6

'This climate of fear is depriving our young people from attending school.'

GLADYS VEGA, chief executive of the La Colaborativa in Chelsea



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Students worked in their fifth-grade Spanish language arts class at the Browne Middle School in Chelsea last month.

AS FEAR RISES, SCHOOL ENROLLMENT FALLS

Chelsea officials cite ICE enforcement as factor in significant drop

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

CHELSEA — Chelsea Public Schools have lost about 350 students this year, the district's biggest enrollment drop in the last decade, partly because of heavy immigration enforcement and families' fear of deportation, district leaders said.

In the city of about 40,000, where immigrants make up almost half of the population, many immigration and education leaders said they believe Chelsea has become a target of the Trump administration's growing enforcement operations.

And as one of the school dis-



Multilingual-learner educator Alyssa Cabrera helped Jarlin Quinonez Mendez at the Browne school.

tricts with the highest Latino populations in the region, many advocates fear Chelsea could offer an early portrait of what educators will see this year as ICE agents increasingly roll out operations in neighborhoods with high concentrations of immigrants.

The Boston Globe asked 13 local districts with high numbers of English learners whether they are facing enrollment declines, and whether such declines are connected to immigration issues, including deportations and fears of ICE.

Four districts provided enrollment numbers showing declines.

ABSENCES, Page A6

Vestige of the past, cautionary tale for today

'Iron lung,' a medical relic, still stirs memories of life without vaccines

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Tucked away in the basement of the Harvard Medical School library is a large capsule-like contraption on wheels that is both a relic of the past and, public health experts warn, a caution for the future.

The machine is an "iron lung," the external ventilator that inspired fear but also provided hope to generations of children who were ravaged by polio in the first

half of the 20th century. The device helped patients paralyzed by the polio virus breathe while they recovered but became all but obsolete after the introduction of polio vaccines in the 1950s and '60s.

But public health experts and pediatricians now worry that debilitating childhood diseases like polio could make a comeback in the United States as the Trump administration, led by Secretary of Health and Human Services

IRON LUNG, Page A7

A PATRIOTS STUNNER



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

New England went onto the home field of the NFL's last remaining unbeaten team Sunday. The result: a thrilling, final-minute win, 23-20, over the Buffalo Bills. Above, defensive tackle Joshua Farmer celebrated a Bills turnover. C1.



A summer fling

Monday: Very warm. High 78-83, low 57-62.

Tuesday: Similar, breezy. Weather and comics, D4-5.

Obituaries, B6.

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A Trump administration proposal could make it harder for older Americans to qualify for Social Security disability payments. A2.

Harvard researchers developed a trivia game aimed at bridging political chasms. D1.

Another barrage of Russian missiles and attack drones pummeled Ukraine's energy infrastructure. A3.

The Red Sox could face a potentially transformative offseason, with plenty of roster churning. C1.

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